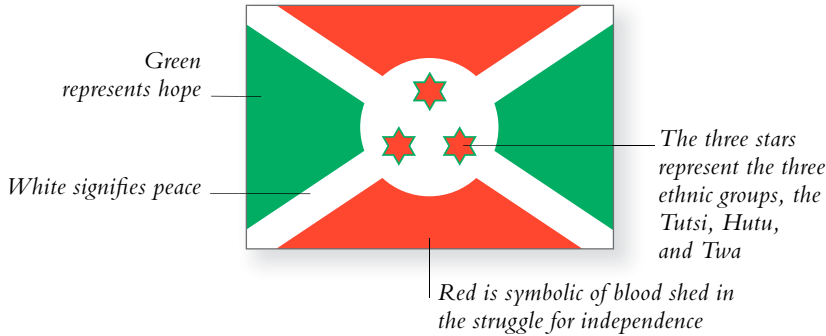


Burundi

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** June 28, 1967 **Usage:** National and Civil



Africa



Like Rwanda, **Burundi** was a German, then a Belgian territory. It achieved independence as a kingdom in 1962 and became a republic in 1966.

The flag adopted at independence had a drum—symbolic of the monarchy—and a sorghum plant in the central disc. When the kingdom was abolished the drum was removed, and a year later the sorghum plant was replaced by the three stars, said to symbolize the main ethnic groups.

THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms has also been altered. The royal drum which was above the shield was removed, a more republican motto was adopted, and the four spears were reduced to three, again to represent the ethnic groups. The golden lion's face also featured on the royal badge.

ARMS OF BURUNDI

